

Moonsea Rising - 20240505

Friday Night Magic

At Lennox's questioning, Lirael opens the portable hole and finds the tarot of The Chest, rather than the chest she was expecting. Reaching out in her mind, she finds the General still there.

Quickly sketching the map from the floor, they move to track the other points that were being tracked by the shop owner, before malign forces find them. The nearest is Historia Reliquery. Arakinesh the Wise introduces himself, asking them what they're seeking. Taevyn immediately asks about The War of the Crown. He is immediately dismissive.

Harken whispers to Lirael about getting some local histories. She notes that there are several magical tomes, as well as something in a small box on the counter behind him.

Lirael asks him about books on the history of the region, and he mentions having works on Melvaunt, Thar, and Tuscabibble's History of the Mad King. She tells him the latter, of which he has five of the six volumes, is probably too nice an item for their travels, but the former two are certainly of interest.

Beitris finds a work on the noble houses of Melvaunt, and recognizes the crests of Marsk, Brule, Shadowbanks, Norster, Larrigen, and Barrigen. She doesn't see Kilaudra, Tuscabibble, Moje, or El Gata. She asks him about Tuscabibble's Guide, and he tells her it was written by Rudolpho Tuscabibble at least 150 years ago. She haggles with him briefly, before buying it at the outrageous 15gp he asks.

Harken messages Lirael, asking if maybe he should reveal himself. She's doubtful on that, but suggests that if he can see what's in the box, that would be useful. Making himself invisible, he sneaks over and sees that it's The Talon.

Lennox manages to haggle him down on a history of Thar. Arakinesh becomes much more talkative, and asks Lirael about her eye patch. She tells him she's sacrificed it to Gruumsh, and he becomes excited. He shows her a tarot of the Chieftan, whom he believes to be Lorfax, possibly the first King of Thar. He describes it as the pride of his collection, and Lirael expresses interest in buying it. He offers it for 75gp. She counters that he should allow her to identify it first.

She finds the card is a mimic, possibly used for cheating at cards. He fumfers about Dieral Myrnese selling him garbage, and offers Lirael the first volume of the Mad King in apology. She decides to buy the rest of the set, and he is ecstatic. When Beitris asks, he tells her that Dieral is friendly with Clemeth at the Reclaimed Paradise, and also a collector of tattoos, so he might be found at the Kraken's Ink.

Beitris' card is still pointing towards the back of the shop, so they step outside to see if it's pointing beyond the shop, which it appears to be. Belaying following that for the moment, they follow the map they made to the second shop in the bazaar, which turns out to be Kraken's Ink.

Nautically themed and smelling of salt, they find the proprietor talking to a man who is looking at his book for possible new art. Taevyn immediately asks him if he can do a magical triangle teeth tattoo. While he does the tattoo, Lennox and Beitris butter him up, and find out that he did a tattoo that looked very much like Lirael with a giant lizard for Dieral earlier that day.

Leaving and following the card, they find it directing them well towards the east gate, until it shifts hard-right before a compound by the gate. As Beitris wanders over to the gate, she sees the destrier in the paddock is exceedingly well-cared-for. Taevyn goes to knock on the door of the main building, getting no response. Harken peeks through the wall, finding someone sitting quietly in the dark, looking around and hoping to go unnoticed. He has a stack of cards with him. Taevyn picks the outside lock, and they enter, calling for Dieral. Harken gestures to the small room, and Dieral tells them he's not there. When Taevyn opens his door, he begs them not to kill him, telling them the cards have shown him visions of them coming to kill him.

Taevyn asks him about the cards. He looks scared and says, "no, no, no," as several men storm into the barn.

Give Me that Shiny Rare

The attackers begin firing arrows at Dieral, telling him he knows why they're here to kill him. A creature with a number of bizarre limbs attacks Harken's mind with crushing despair. Beitris summons her spiritual weapon, swinging it at one of the attackers, as another fells Lirael in two swift stabs of her rapier. A massive red-skinned humanoid sizes up Lennox, and steps up to attack him, grinning. He smashes the large man with his axe, and tells him "if you leave now, I won't kill you." Lennox attacks him back, at the man laughs.

Dieral slams the inner door in Taevyn's face as the younger man calls him a coward. Harken struggles against the magical emotions swirling through him, and stabilizes Lirael before she can die. Taevyn tumbles through the big man, slashing at him, and takes an arrow from one of the assassins. They fire on Lennox as well, striking him with several arrows. The inhuman mage casts a series of magical missiles at Taevyn, then ducks back outside and under cover.

Beitris tells the large man, "I will take what I came for and leave. But one must pay the price. You choose." Beitris heals the room, and the commander demands she name someone, or the deal is off. She offers herself, as Lennox and Taevyn both move to intercept her.

Lirael, however, stands up. Looking at the red-skinned man. She declaims, "I demand you take your men and leave." He points at her and says, "this isn't over," and turns to leave.

She collapses back to the floor as they depart. Taevyn rushes over to her with his healing kit and begins working on her. As everyone stares on, aghast, her skin begins to darken, her features roughen, and small tusks extrude from lower jaw. Beitris casts another large heal, closing her wounds, but she doesn't immediately regain consciousness.